



AL MAAREF AMERICAN SCHOOL

MAS Inclusion Policy

ACADEMIC YEAR

2026 – 2027

1. Policy Statement

Al Maaref American School (MAS) is committed to providing a high-quality, inclusive education for all students.

We believe every learner can succeed academically, socially, emotionally, and behaviorally when barriers to learning are identified and addressed through equitable access, high expectations, and a coherent tiered support system. Support is responsive to diverse needs, including Students of Determination, English Language Learners, students performing significantly above or below grade-level expectations, and students with behavioral, social, or emotional needs.

2. Scope

This policy applies to:

- All students enrolled at MAS
- All staff (academic, administrative, and support)
- All phases of the student journey (admissions, placement, teaching & learning, assessment, promotion, and exit/transition)

3. Definitions

- **Inclusion** – Ensuring that all students, regardless of ability, language, background, or need, participate meaningfully in school life and have access to high-quality, grade-level instruction in the least restrictive environment.
- **Special Educational Need (SEN)** – Educational needs differing from those of the majority of students, arising from the impact of a disability or recognized disorder.
- **Disability** – A long-term physical, sensory, mental, or intellectual impairment that restricts participation in daily activities.
- **Students of Determination** – Students with identified or suspected long-term or short-term learning difficulties, disabilities, or barriers that require additional or different support to access the curriculum and school life.
- **Tiered Support System** – A proactive, data-informed framework with three tiers of increasing intensity (Tier 1, Tier 2, Tier 3) that organizes universal classroom support, targeted interventions, and intensive individualized support.

4. Legislation

MAS ensures full compliance with:

- UAE Federal Law No. 29 (2006) on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities
- UAE Federal Law No. 2 (2015) Against Discrimination and Hatred
- Dubai Law No. 2 (2014)
- Executive Council Resolution No. 2 (2017) – Private Schools Regulation
- Dubai Inclusive Education Policy Framework (2017)
- UAE Categorization Framework 2019–2020
- UAE Federal Decree-Law No. 45 of 2021 on the Protection of Personal Data (PDPL)

MAS fully adopts the principles of the UN Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities (UNCRPD).

5. Guiding Principles

1. All Students Can Succeed

We believe in the potential of every student to achieve success when provided with appropriate instruction, support, and high expectations.

2. Tiered Support for Diverse Needs

We provide a continuum of supports, from universal to intensive, so that students receive the right support at the right time.

3. Data-Informed Decision Making

Decisions about instruction, intervention, and placement are based on high-quality data, including universal screening, progress monitoring, diagnostic assessment, and professional judgment.

4. Evidence-Based Practice

Interventions and strategies used at MAS are grounded in research and monitored for effectiveness.

5. Collaborative Team Approach

Inclusion is a shared responsibility. Teachers, leaders, support staff, parents, and students work together to design and implement support plans.

6. Least Restrictive Environment

Students are educated alongside their peers as much as possible. Pull-out or highly individualized programs are used only when essential for student progress.

7. Respect, Dignity, and High Expectations

All students are treated with dignity and are expected to engage in challenging, age-appropriate learning that promotes independence and self-advocacy.

6. Our Aims

MAS aims to:

- Maintain a clear, comprehensive, and transparent Inclusion Policy.
- Ensure equitable access to educational opportunities for all students.
- Embed an inclusive ethos, culture, and climate across the school.
- Ensure structures, systems, and policies uphold UAE National Agenda and KHDA expectations.
- Implement a **Tiered Support System (Tiers 1–3)**.
- Ensure all staff share responsibility for supporting every learner.
- Celebrate diversity as a strength.

7. Categorization of Need

MAS identifies Students of Determination in line with the UAE Unified National Classification of Disabilities (People of Determination).

Table 1: Every student of determination (student with a formal diagnosis) must be classified under one of the 11 main categories.

Main Diagnosed Category	Sub-Category as per the UAE unified classification system	Additional Information
1. Intellectual Disability	1.1 Intellectual Disability	▶ Mild ▶ Moderate ▶ Severe
	1.2 Unspecified	▶ Mild ▶ Moderate ▶ Severe
	1.3 Global Developmental Delay	
	1.4 Neurocognitive Disorders	
2. Communication Disorders	2.1 Language Disorders	▶ Receptive ▶ Expressive ▶ Both receptive and expressive
	2.2 Speech Sounds Disorder	
	2.3 Fluency Disorder	
	2.4 Social Communication Disorder	
	2.5 Unspecified Communication Disorder	
3. Autism Spectrum Disorder	3.1 Autism with Intellectual Disability	▶ Level 1 ▶ Level 2 ▶ Level 3
	3.2 High Functioning Autism	▶ Level 1 ▶ Level 2 ▶ Level 3
4. ADHD	4.1 Combined presentation	

	4.2 Predominately Inattentive presentation	
	4.3 Predominantly Hyperactive/Impulsive	
5. Psycho-Emotional Disorders	▶ Depression ▶ bipolar disorder ▶ anxiety disorders ▶ Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder ▶ obsessive compulsive disorder ▶ Oppositional Defiance Disorder ▶ Conduct Disorder ▶ Selective Mutism ▶ Intermittent Explosive Disorder ▶ eating disorders ▶ Personality Disorders ▶ Tourette Syndrome ▶ Other	
6. Specific Learning Difficulties	6.1 Dyslexia	
	6.2 Dysgraphia	
	6.3 Dyscalculia	
	6.4 Scholastic Skills	
7. Visual Impairment	7.1 Total Blindness	
	7.2 Partially Sighted	
	7.3 Low Vision	▶ Mild ▶ Moderate ▶ Severe
8. Hearing Impairment	8.1 Deafness (hearing loss greater than 90 decibels)	
	8.2-Hearing Impairment (hearing loss ranging from 26 to 90 decibels)	▶ Mild ▶ Moderate ▶ Severe
9. Deaf-Blind Disability	9.1 Deaf-Blind	

10. Physical Disability	▶ Cerebral Palsy ▶ Muscular Dystrophy ▶ Spina Bifida ▶ Amputation/Limb Differences ▶ Spinal Cord Injury ▶ DCD / Dyspraxia ▶ Brittle Bone Disease ▶ Juvenile Idiopathic Arthritis. ▶ Musculoskeletal Deformities ▶ Other	
11. Multiple Disability	When selecting Multiple Disabilities, also select two or more additional main and sub-categories that coexist and result in complex needs requiring highly individualized support and consistent specialist input.	

Table 2: Every identified student (student with evidence-based indicators of a disability) must be categorised using the barrier categories below.

Main Barrier	Barrier Sub-Category	Additional Information
1. Thinking and Learning Needs	- General learning needs across subjects - Early developmental needs (under age 5) - Memory and thinking needs due to illness or injury	- Learns with some extra support (can follow most learning with adjustments and guidance) -Learns with regular support (needs frequent adaptations and help across subjects) - Learns with high levels of support (requires ongoing, personalised support in most areas of daily academic life)
2. Communication and Speech Needs	- Language needs - Difficulty making speech sounds clearly - - Stammering or stuttering - Social use of language difficulties - Other or unclear speech and language needs	Understanding / Using / Both
3. Social Communication and Interaction Needs	- Needs little - Regular - high levels of support	
4. Attention and Focus Needs	- Difficulties with both attention and high activity - Difficulties mainly with attention and focus - Difficulties mainly with high activity and impulsive behaviour	
5. Social, Emotional and Behavioural Needs	Low mood, mood swings, anxiety, trauma, OCD, defiance, selective mutism, outbursts, eating	

Main Barrier	Barrier Sub-Category	Additional Information
	difficulties, personality/behaviour challenges, tics, other	
6. Learning Difficulties in Specific Skills	- Reading difficulties - Writing difficulties - Difficulties with maths and number skills - General academic learning difficulties	
7. Vision Needs	Low vision	Some / Significant / Very limited visual clarity
8. Hearing Needs	Hearing loss	Some / Frequent / Unable to hear most speech
9. Physical and Movement Needs	Movement, posture, muscle weakness, coordination, fragile bones, joint problems, limb differences, spinal injury, bone/joint differences, other	
10. Multiple and Complex Needs	Two or more co-existing barriers requiring highly individualised support	Record each relevant barrier category

8. Whole School Commitment to Inclusion

MAS is committed to:

- Equitable access to all learning opportunities.
- A culture that rejects ability labelling and celebrates diversity.
- Reasonable accommodations for Students of Determination.
- Staff training, coaching, and co-teaching models.
- Recognizing Emirati students as a priority cohort, in line with national expectations.
- Guaranteeing no student is denied admission based on disability.

Inclusion Support Team (IST)

Our Inclusion Support Team (IST) includes:

- School Principal/Director
- Section Principals
- Director of Inclusion
- Head of Inclusion
- Inclusion Champions
- Learning Support Assistants (LSAs)

The following parties attend meetings as needed:

- Counsellor
- Director of Wellbeing
- Parent Representative
- External Specialists
- School Nurse/Doctor



The IST meets monthly to review cases, oversee Tier 2 and Tier 3 supports, monitor IEP implementation, allocate LSAs dynamically, and document actions and impact.

9. Responsibilities for Inclusion

(See Appendix I for full role descriptions.)

- **School Principal/Director** – Leads and champions inclusion; allocates resources; ensures compliance.
- **Section Principals & HODs** – Monitor implementation, support teachers, ensure IEPs are followed.
- **Head of Inclusion (HoI)** – Leads identification, evaluation, and intervention; assigns and oversees LSAs; ensures fidelity of IEP delivery.
- **Learning Support Assistants (LSAs)** – Provide instructional support; collect data; deliver pull-out as specified in the IEP.
- **Parent-Appointed ILSAs (Individual Learning Support Assistants)** – support student independence under school supervision and the student's IEP.
- **Teachers** – Deliver high-quality differentiated instruction; implement accommodations and modifications documented in the IEP.
- **Parents** – Share reports; participate in IEP meetings and reviews; support recommended strategies at home.

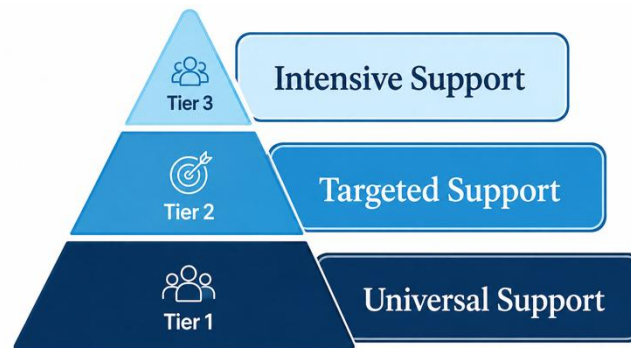
10. Admissions and Participation

- Al Maaref American School (MAS) is committed to an inclusive admissions process that ensures Students of Determination are welcomed without discrimination. The detailed admissions procedures for Students of Determination including selection criteria, entrance assessment, conditional offers, and exceptional cases are set out in full in the **MAS Admissions Policy (Section 7: Identification as Students of Determination - Inclusion)**. This section summarizes the key principles that govern how admissions and inclusion intersect.

Key principles include:

- Non-Discriminatory Admission:** MAS does not refuse admission on the basis of disability or additional learning needs.
- Transparent Communication:** The school maintains honest and open dialogue with parents throughout the admissions process, providing clear explanations of available services, resources, and support pathways.
- Fair Financial Practices:** No additional fees are charged for inclusion support provided by the school. The only exception is for optional parent-appointed LSAs, which remain at the discretion of families.
- Assessment for Planning, Not Eligibility:** Information gathered during the admissions process — including language proficiency results, school readiness observations, Individualized Education Plans (IEPs), and psychological or medical reports — is used to plan the appropriate support pathway for the student, not as a pass/fail eligibility measure.
- Conditional Offers of a Place:** MAS may issue a conditional offer where further information, documentation, or a short settling-in period is needed to confirm the most effective support arrangements. A conditional offer is never used as a means of declining admission on the basis of a student's disability or additional needs. Full conditions and procedures are detailed in the Admissions Policy.
- Individual Learning Support Assistant (1:1 LSA) at the Point of Entry:** Where documented observations or a risk assessment identify significant concerns regarding a student's safety, safeguarding, independence, or risk of harm during the admissions process, a temporary 1:1 LSA may form part of the student's admission and transition plan. This requirement is based on individually assessed needs and safety considerations, not on disability or diagnosis alone, and is regularly reviewed.
- Collaborative Decision-Making in Exceptional Cases:** In the rare event that a student's needs exceed the school's capacity to provide safe and appropriate support — even with reasonable adjustments MAS works in partnership with the family before any final decision. This includes a meeting between the family, the Head of Inclusion, and the school principal; full consideration of possible reasonable adjustments; and consultation with KHDA in line with its inclusive education procedures. Any decision not to proceed with admission is communicated to the family in writing, with reasons, and reviewed and approved by the school principal.
- New Student Transition Planning:** Admission is recognized as the first transition point in the student's inclusion journey. New students joining MAS follow the transition procedures set out in Section 21 (Student Transition Policy), including records request, placement assessment, and Tier assignment within two weeks of enrollment.

11. Tiered Support System & Levels of Support



Tier 1 – Universal Support

High-quality instruction for all students with differentiation, positive behavior support, and regular screening.

Tier 2 – Targeted Support

Small group, evidence-based interventions for students identified as at risk. Support is short-term, focused, and monitored regularly.

Entry Criteria:

- Student performing below grade-level expectations after 4–8 weeks of quality Tier 1 instruction.
- Evidence required: MAP/CAT4 data, teacher observation, and universal screening results.

Delivery:

- Tier 2 interventions are primarily delivered by the Learning Support Teacher (LST) in collaboration with the classroom teacher.
- Sessions: 20–30 minutes, 2–3 times per week (or per program guidelines).
- Each session must be recorded in the student's Data Action Plan within 24 hours of delivery.

Progress Monitoring:

- Progress is reviewed at least monthly to assess response and adjust support.

Exit Criteria:

- Student demonstrates consistent progress toward grade-level benchmarks across two consecutive monitoring cycles, as confirmed by the Hol.

Tier 3 – Intensive Support

Individualized, high-frequency interventions for students with significant or persistent needs. Plans are personalized and may involve external specialists. The IEP guides and documents all Tier 3 provision.

12. Referral and Identification Process

Identification can occur at any point during the academic year and may be initiated by parents, teachers, supervisors, HODs, the school doctor, or administrative staff.

12.1 Pre-Referral Student Support

- Universal screening (e.g., MAP, CAT4, NGRT, ABT, school-wide benchmarks)
- Ongoing teacher assessment and observation aligned to CCSS and California grade-level expectations
- Progress monitoring in literacy, numeracy, and class participation
- Tier 1 support provided in the classroom
- If a student continues to perform below grade-level expectations, targeted Tier 2 intervention begins, and an IEP may be considered as needs escalate.

12.2 Referral

A formal referral is made when:

- The student does not make adequate progress after Tier 1 and Tier 2 supports
- A parent requests formal support
- A staff member identifies consistent barriers to learning

Referral submission to the Hol must include teacher observations, work samples, screening results (MAP, CAT4, running records), parent communication, and classroom strategies attempted.

Referral and Identification Timelines:

Step	Step	Timeframe	Notes
1	Observe & log	First 2 -4 weeks	First 2 -4 weeks Logged on the Initial Concern Form
2	Tier 1 plan	4–8 weeks	Referred via Referral Form; Learning Support Plan; if student improves → stays at Tier 1 If student didn't improve → shift to Tire 2
3	Tier 2 plan	4–8 weeks	individualized/accommodation plan Learning Support Plan; if student improves → stays at Tier 2 If student didn't improve → shift to Tire 3 (As needed)
4	Team & consent	As needed	Team + parent meeting; consent for diagnosis
5	Register & support	Upon completion	Student placed at Tier 3; IEP begins

		of the requirements	
	First IEP progress review	4 – 6 weeks	The IEPs will be reviewed periodically to monitor the student's progress.

Fast-Track branch:

Condition	Action	Timeframe
Existing outside diagnosis, or a safeguarding/wellbeing concern	Skips steps 1–3, goes straight to a Team & Parent Meeting	Within 2 working days

12.3 Parent Consent

After referral, a meeting with parents is scheduled and consent secured for evaluation.

12.4 Evaluation

Led by the Hol with a multidisciplinary team: inclusion specialist, class/subject teachers, parent, LSA (if applicable), counselor/therapists (as needed). Evaluation may include classroom observation, curriculum-based assessments aligned to CCSS, MAP/CAT4 analysis, literacy and math diagnostics, language proficiency for ELL students, and behavior monitoring. External assessments (psychoeducational, speech therapy, occupational therapy, etc.) may be recommended when needed.

12.5 Eligibility Decision

Results are reviewed with teachers and parents; the student is placed under the appropriate Tier, added to the Inclusion Register, and—when individualized provision is required—an IEP is developed.

13. Individualized Education Plan (IEP)

The IEP is the sole individualized plan recognized by this policy.

13.1 Purpose

The IEP documents individualized goals, accommodations, modifications (if applicable), and services for students requiring intensive, personalized support.

13.2 Development

IEPs at MAS are:

- Jointly developed with parents, teachers, and specialists
- Data-driven and barrier-focused
- Standards-aligned (CCSS/MOE) or modified when needed

- Reviewed quarterly and renewed annually
- Accessible to all staff working with the student

IEPs include: student profile; assessment data; SMART goals; accommodations; modifications (if applicable); intervention/service schedule; LSA support (if required); and progress monitoring.

13.3 Delivery & Evaluation

The HoI oversees implementation. Where required, an LSA can be assigned to the student or a small group. Progress is monitored using a formal tracking procedure. The IEP is reviewed formally at least once per term, with additional reviews scheduled upon parent, teacher, or specialist request, and renewed in full at the end of each academic year.

14. Curriculum Access, Accommodations & Modifications

Students registered on Tier 2 may receive instructional accommodations plan and/or LSP learning support plan, pull-out / push-in / intervention.

Students registered on Tier 3 may receive instructional accommodations plan and/or curriculum modifications as documented in their IEP, pull-out / push-in 1:1 or small group lessons.

- Accommodations (do not change learning outcomes): extra time; clarified instructions; visual aids/graphic organizers; chunked tasks; reduced item count; assistive technology; alternative response modes; quiet testing environment.
- Modifications (for significant needs only): reduced complexity; reduced DOK; adjusted outcomes; replacement/functional skills curriculum; modified Arabic tasks. All modifications must be documented on the IEP, explained to parents, and reviewed quarterly.

15. Pull-out Intervention

High-intensity intervention delivered outside the classroom according to student need and IEP specifications. Pull-out:

- Must not replace core instruction
- Must be time-limited and goal-oriented
- Must be documented after every session
- Must be reviewed regularly for impact
- Delivered only by trained specialists, without removing students from core instruction unless unavoidable and documented
- The number of students in the group should not exceed 6 students per teacher.

16. Assessment, Exams & Access Arrangements

MAS ensures inclusive assessment practices and compliance with MAP, NGRT, MOE Arabic guidelines, and external exam requirements. The following access arrangements are available:

Category	Access Arrangements / Accommodations
1. Extra Time	Additional time may be provided according to the student's identified needs and approved support plan (e.g., 25% extra time or as determined appropriate).
2. Supervised Rest Breaks	Short, supervised breaks may be provided during the assessment without academic assistance being given during the break.
3. Flexible Scheduling	The assessment may be divided into shorter sessions or scheduled at an appropriate time when this supports the student's documented needs.
4. Separate / Small-Group Setting	The student may complete the assessment individually or within a small group when a quieter or more structured environment is required.
5. Reduced-Distraction Environment	Preferential seating, a quiet testing area, reduced visual/auditory distractions, or an alternative testing location may be provided.
6. Presentation of Assessment	Enlarged font, increased spacing, simplified page layout, coloured paper or overlays, highlighting of key instructions, or presenting one section/page at a time may be used where appropriate.
7. Clarification of Instructions	Instructions may be repeated, rephrased, or clarified to ensure the student understands what is required, without explaining the answer, changing the academic demand, or providing additional academic guidance.
8. Reading Support	An authorised staff member may read questions or instructions aloud where this is an approved accommodation and where reading itself is not the skill being assessed. Text-to-Speech may also be used where appropriate and permitted.
9. Scribe / Recording Verbal Responses	The Inclusion Teacher or an authorised staff member may write or type the student's answers exactly as verbally dictated by the student, according to the student's individual needs. The staff member must not prompt, correct, guide, interpret, or influence the student's responses.
10. Oral Response	Where appropriate, the student may provide answers verbally rather than in writing. The student's responses may be recorded verbatim by the Inclusion Teacher or another authorised staff member.
11. Use of Computer / Assistive Technology	The student may use a computer or laptop, Speech-to-Text, Text-to-Speech, adapted keyboard/mouse, or other approved educational technology where appropriate and permitted.
12. Sensory Support	Approved sensory tools, noise-reduction headphones, visual timers, or other appropriate sensory-regulation resources may be provided when required.

13. Movement & Physical Arrangements	Movement breaks, adapted seating, alternative seating positions, additional working space, or permission to change position may be provided according to individual needs.
14. Attention & Emotional Regulation Support	A quiet/calming space, visual schedule, visual timer, structured breaks, task chunking, or other agreed strategies may be used to support attention, anxiety, or emotional regulation without providing academic assistance.
15. Medical / Health Arrangements	Medical or rest breaks, access to medication, toilet breaks, food/drink where medically required, and other appropriate health-related arrangements may be provided according to the student's documented needs.
16. Modified Assessment	Where specified in the student's IEP or individual learning programme, the assessment may be modified through adapted content, reduced complexity, adjusted learning outcomes, alternative assessment tasks, or assessment against the student's individual learning objectives.

All access arrangements must be documented in the student's IEP and communicated to subject teachers at least one week prior to any formal assessment.

17. Collaboration with Families & External Agencies

MAS collaborates with parents throughout identification, consent, IEP development, and review. The school maintains transparent communication regarding any curriculum modifications and shares strategies for home support. MAS works, as needed, with speech and language therapists, occupational therapists, behavior therapists, psychologists, medical professionals, and social workers.

18. Monitoring, Evaluation & Reporting

MAS tracks student progress regularly, maintains data on Students of Determination, monitors IEP impact, reports outcomes to leadership, evaluates inclusion annually, incorporates inclusion indicators into SEF and SIP, and reviews this policy annually.

19. GATE Program (Gifted and Talented Education)

Identification of Gifted and Talented students is based on a holistic, data-driven process using multiple measures (MAP Growth, CAT4, teacher recommendations, classroom performance, and observable talent). Identification is reviewed annually.

19.1 Definitions

- Gifted: Students who demonstrate exceptional cognitive ability or potential significantly above age expectations. A formal IQ diagnosis is not required in UAE schools.
- Talented: Students who show outstanding ability or potential in non-academic domains such as visual/performing arts, sports, music, creativity, innovation, or leadership.

19.2 Eligibility Criteria

Gifted (Academic + Cognitive Ability):

- MAP Growth $\geq$ 95th percentile
- CAT4 SAS $\geq$ 120 in two or more batteries

Talented:

- Portfolio/performance evidence
- Teacher/coach recommendation
- Competition results or certifications
- CAT4 Spatial/Verbal SAS $\geq$ 120 (supportive, not mandatory)

19.3 Identification Process

- Teacher, self, peer, or parent nominations
- Classroom observations and performance evidence
- MAP and CAT4 data analysis
- Portfolios, competition results, and talent demonstrations
- Review by the GATE Committee (HOD + Inclusion + SLT)
- Decisions rely on triangulated evidence, not a single score

19.4 Provision for GATE Students

- Curriculum differentiation and extension
- Curriculum acceleration (subject-based or flexible pacing)
- Enrichment projects and research opportunities
- Inquiry-based learning with real-world applications
- Advanced problem-solving and critical-thinking tasks
- Participation in clubs, competitions, STEM programs, arts showcases
- Cross-age leadership or tutoring roles
- Individual Advanced Learning Plans (ALPs) with monitoring

19.5 Roles and Responsibilities

- Head of Inclusion: oversees GATE identification and support; ensures best practice and aligned strategies.
- GATE Champions: maintain registers, monitor progress, facilitate competitions/enrichment, and support teachers with differentiation tools.
- Section Principals and HODs: adapt curriculum maps to include enrichment and challenge; support planning.
- Teachers: identify gifted/advanced learners and plan differentiated lessons aligned with CCSS; provide higher-order tasks, acceleration, and independent projects.

20. Exit from the Inclusion Register

A student may be moved down a Tier or removed from the Inclusion Register only when consistent, data-evidenced progress has been demonstrated across a minimum of two consecutive review cycles.

- Exit decisions are made collaboratively by the HoI, class/subject teachers, and parents.
- Parents receive written notification and explanation prior to any register change.
- Following exit, the student is monitored under enhanced Tier 1 for a minimum of one term before full removal from monitoring.
- All exit decisions are recorded in the student file and reported to SLT.

21. Student Transition Policy

MAS recognizes that transitions between school phases present significant risk points for Students of Determination. Structured transition planning is required at each of the following points:

Transition Point	Timeframe for Planning	Key Actions
Early years → Grade 2 (Elementary)	By end of Spring term	Handover meeting for recommendations, record transfer, parent consultation, IEP handover
Elementary → Middle School	By end of Spring term	Handover meeting for recommendations, record transfer, parent consultation, IEP handover
Middle → High School (Grade 9)	By end of Spring term	Academic pathway review, Handover meeting for recommendations, record transfer, parent consultation, IEP handover.
New student joining MAS	Within 2 weeks of enrollment	Records request, placement assessment, Tier assignment
Student exiting MAS	4 weeks before departure	Transfer summary, records package, parent sign-off

Minimum Requirements for All Transitions:

- Handover meeting between sending and receiving section (minimum 2 weeks before transition)
- Transfer of IEP, assessment data, and all support records
- Parent consultation and written acknowledgment
- Transition plan documented in student file
- Follow-up review within 4 weeks of transition completion

22. Confidentiality & Data Protection

Student records—including assessment data, IEPs, and external reports—are treated as confidential and shared only with staff who need this information to support the student. Data is stored, used, and retained in line with school and regulatory data protection requirements.

MAS complies fully with UAE Federal Decree-Law No. 45 of 2021 on the Protection of Personal Data (PDPL), ensuring that all student data is collected, stored, processed, and shared in accordance with applicable federal requirements.

23. Professional Learning

MAS commits to ongoing professional development so that teachers and leaders understand inclusive practices, differentiation, behavior support, and culturally responsive teaching. New staff receive induction on this policy, IEP procedures, and the Student Support Services Handbook.

24. Policy Review

This policy is reviewed annually.

Approved by	School Senior Leadership Team (SLT)
Effective Date	2026 – 2027
Next Review	August, 2027 - 2028
Last Amended	August, 2026/ Inclusion Policy Review

Appendix I — Responsibilities for Inclusion

1. Inclusion Governor / School Owner Representative

- Oversee development, implementation, and monitoring of the Inclusion Policy.
- Ensure appropriate staffing and resources for inclusive education.
- Monitor inclusion within the School Improvement Plan.
- Receive regular updates from the Principal and Hol.

2. School Principal / Director

- Lead and champion the inclusive vision of MAS.
- Ensure whole-school compliance with UAE laws and KHDA expectations.
- Allocate resources (staff, budget, training) to support inclusion.
- Oversee Section Principals and the Hol.
- Report to the Inclusion Governor / School Owner on the progress of Students of Determination.

3. Section Principals & HODs

- Monitor inclusion practices daily within their phase (KG / Elementary / Secondary).
- Support teachers in implementing accommodations and classroom strategies.
- Ensure IEPs are followed consistently in their section.
- Collaborate with the Hol on referrals, evaluations, and supports.
- Ensure staff attend meetings, training, and planning requirements for inclusion.

4. Head of Inclusion (Hol)

Leadership & Compliance:

- Lead strategic and operational implementation of inclusion across the school; ensure compliance with KHDA and UAE legislation; provide termly reports.

Identification & Support:

- Lead screening, early support, and tier movement; coordinate evaluations; assign and oversee LSAs.

Teaching & Support:

- Guide teachers on curriculum adaptation, accommodations, and modifications; support IEP implementation.

Oversight & Monitoring:

- Monitor classroom implementation through walkthroughs and observations; review student progress data and adjust support.

Parent & Community Collaboration:

- Maintain partnership with parents; liaise with external agencies (therapy, psychology, medical support).

Professional Development:

- Lead training for teachers and LSAs.

5. Learning Support Teacher (LST)

- Plans and delivers targeted interventions for students under Tier 2 and Tier 3.
- Collaborates with classroom teachers to adapt instruction and implement accommodations.

- Monitors student progress and contributes to IEP development and review.
- Provides coaching and modeling of inclusive strategies for teachers.
- Maintains documentation of interventions and progress monitoring.

6. Learning Support Assistants (LSAs)

Instructional Support:

- Support students inside the classroom per teacher/Hol guidance; deliver 1:1 or small-group intervention during pull-out (as per IEP); prepare adapted materials.

Data & Documentation:

- Collect daily progress data; support IEP reviews with observations.

Care & Safeguarding:

- Support personal care needs documented in the IEP; supervise students during transitions, breaks, and field trips.

Professional Expectations:

- Attend training by Hol; follow positive behavior support and safeguarding guidelines.

7. Parent-Appointed LSAs

- Support student independence without replacing the teacher's role.
- Implement strategies agreed with Hol and classroom teachers; follow the student's IEP under school supervision.
- Maintain professional ethics and confidentiality; collaborate without interrupting instructional flow.
- Not permitted to create independent instructional plans, replace the teacher, or interfere with school authority/discipline.

8. Classroom & Subject Teachers

- Deliver high-quality differentiated instruction aligned with CCSS & UAE National Curriculum.
- Implement accommodations and modifications documented in the IEP.
- Participate in referral, evaluation, and IEP planning.
- Collaborate with Hol and LSAs.
- Monitor and record progress of Students of Determination.

9. Parents

- Share relevant assessment or medical reports.
- Participate actively in IEP meetings and reviews.
- Support recommended strategies at home.
- Provide private LSA support if required and approved by the school.

Appendix II — Tiered Support System & Levels of Support

Tier 1 — Core Universal Instruction

- High-quality, research-based classroom instruction aligned to grade-level standards.
- Differentiation to address varied readiness levels, learning profiles, and interests.
- Embedded behavior expectations and social-emotional learning practices.
- Universal screening at least three times per year (Fall, Winter, Spring).

Tier 2 — Targeted Supplemental Interventions

- Students identified as 'at risk' receive additional small-group interventions in specific skill areas.
- Interventions are standardized and evidence-based, delivered for 20–30 minutes, 2–3 times per week.
- Progress monitoring occurs at least monthly to assess response and adjust support.
- Entry: below grade-level performance after 4–6 weeks of Tier 1, evidenced by MAP/CAT4 and teacher observation.
- Exit: consistent progress across two consecutive monitoring cycles confirmed by Hol.
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Tier 3 — Intensive Individualized Interventions

- Students who do not make adequate progress in Tier 2, or who present with significant needs, receive individualized support with specific goals, increased frequency/duration, possible 1:1 instruction, and collaboration with external specialists as needed.
- IEP guides and documents all Tier 3 provision.